

RG10

## Population, Urbanisation and Tribes of Rajasthan

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*Rajasthan Geography is 11-15 questions in every paper and this chapter supplies 2-3 of them. Census indicators by district were asked in 2016, 2018, 2021, 2023 and 2024 - every recent paper. ST population by district was asked in 2013, 2016, 2018 and 2021. Learn the highest-lowest tables cold; that alone covers most of what is asked.*

Everything in the first half of this chapter comes from one document - the Census of India 2011. RPSC does not ask you to interpret it. It asks which district is highest, which is lowest, and which tribe lives where. So this is a memorising chapter, and memorising chapters are the cheapest marks in the paper. The tribes half pays twice, because it overlaps with Rajasthan Art and Culture.

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## Rajasthan Population, Urbanisation & Tribes (Census 2011)

### Headline figures

- 6,85,48,437 = 5.66% of India
- 8th in population, 1st in area
- Growth 21.31% (India 17.70%)
- Density 200 (India 382)
- Sex ratio 928 (India 943)
- Literacy 66.11% (India 74.04%)

### Highest districts

- Jaipur - population & density
- Kota - literacy & urbanisation
- Dungarpur - sex ratio 994
- Banswara - child sex ratio & ST share
- Barmer - decadal growth 32.5%
- Jhunjhunu - male literacy 86.9%

### Lowest districts

- Jaisalmer - density 17, population 6.69 lakh
- Jalore - literacy 54.86%
- Dholpur - sex ratio 846, smallest area
- Jhunjhunu - child sex ratio 837
- Dungarpur - urbanisation 6.4%
- Sri Ganganagar - decadal growth

### Urbanisation

- Urban 24.89%, rural 75.11%
- India urban 31.16% - Rajasthan lags
- Million-plus: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota
- 41 districts, 7 divisions (Dec 2024)

### SC & ST

- SC 17.83% (1.22 crore)
- ST 13.48% (92.38 lakh)
- ST belt - Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur
- SC share highest Sri Ganganagar

### Major tribes

- Meena - largest ST, eastern plains
- Bhil - second, southern hills
- Garasia - third, Sirohi-Udaipur-Pali
- Sahariya - only PVTG, Baran

### Smaller communities

- Damor - Dungarpur, head 'Mukhi'
- Kathodi - Udaipur, makes katha
- Rabari/Raika - camel herders
- Gadia Lohar, Kanjar, Sansi

### Tribal administration

- TAD headquarters - Udaipur
- Tribal Sub-Plan - Fifth Plan, 1974-75
- MADA for scattered pockets
- State Population Policy 2000

## First, fix the base year - why 2011 still rules the paper

Every population number RPSC asks about Rajasthan comes from the Census of India 2011. The 2021 Census was postponed, so 2011 is still the official base. That is good news for you - the numbers have not moved for fifteen years, and

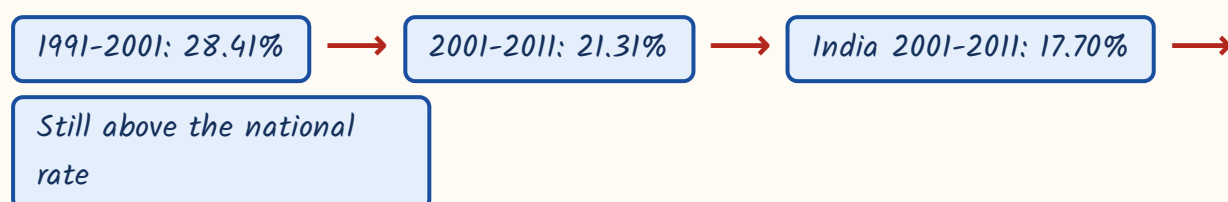
the same figures keep coming back. Whenever you write or recall a population figure, attach the words 'Census 2011' to it in your head. If a question gives you a number without a year, it is a Census 2011 number.

- Census 2011: Rajasthan's population = 6,85,48,437 (about 6.85 crore).
- That is 5.66% of India's population.
- Rank: 8th most populous state of India (Census 2011).
- But Rajasthan is 1st in area - 3,42,239 sq km, 10.41% of India.
- Decadal growth 2001-2011 = 21.31%, against India's 17.70%.
- Rajasthan grew faster than India, but slower than it grew in the previous decade.

#### TRAP

The single most exploited confusion in this chapter: Rajasthan is **FIRST** in area and **EIGHTH** in population. RPSC frames it as 'which of the following is NOT correct' and slips in 'first in population'. Area first, population eighth. Say it aloud.

Rajasthan's growth rate is decelerating - the trend RPSC likes



#### CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the Government of India has notified the next Census for 2027 - reference date 1 March 2027, with 1 October 2026 for snow-bound areas - and it will include caste enumeration. Until its data is published, every Rajasthan population figure in the paper remains a Census 2011 figure. Expect a general-awareness question on the census schedule itself rather than on new numbers.

## The six headline indicators - Rajasthan set against India

Learn these six side by side with the all-India figure. RPSC's favourite trick is a statement question where the Rajasthan number is right but the comparison with India is flipped. Rajasthan is below India on density, sex ratio, child sex ratio, literacy and urbanisation. It is above India only on growth rate. That one asymmetry answers half the statement questions in this chapter.

### Census 2011 - Rajasthan vs India, the numbers that get asked

| Indicator                | Rajasthan 2011               | India 2011   |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|--------------|
| Population               | 6,85,48,437 (5.66% of India) | 121.09 crore |
| Decadal growth 2001-11   | 21.31% (higher)              | 17.70%       |
| Density (persons/sq km)  | 200 (was 165 in 2001)        | 382          |
| Sex ratio (F per 1000 M) | 928                          | 943          |
| Child sex ratio (0-6)    | 888                          | 919          |
| Literacy - overall       | 66.11%                       | 74.04%       |
| Literacy - male          | 79.19%                       | 82.14%       |
| Literacy - female        | 52.12%                       | 65.46%       |
| Urban share              | 24.89%                       | 31.16%       |

Look hard at the literacy line. Male 79.19 and female 52.12 leaves a gender gap of about 27 percentage points - the widest among the major states of India. That gap is itself an examinable fact, not just an arithmetic by-product. And note that Rajasthan's literacy in 2001 was 60.41%, so the decade added roughly six points. Carry the four-number string in your head - 200, 928, 888, 66.11 - density, sex ratio, child sex ratio, literacy, in that order, and notice that the child sex ratio is LOWER than the overall sex ratio.

### ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - Rajasthan's sex ratio as per Census 2011? Answer: 928 females per 1000 males, against the all-India 943. Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - Rajasthan's literacy rate? Answer: 66.11%.

## Highest and lowest districts - the matching set RPSC loves most

This is the heart of the chapter. Almost every census question in RAS is a highest-lowest question or a four-pair matching question built from the two tables below. Do not read them once. Write them out from memory until they come without effort. Note the district names are as they stood in Census 2011, before the 2023 reorganisation.

### HIGHEST district for each indicator - Census 2011

| Indicator              | Highest district | Figure           |
|------------------------|------------------|------------------|
| Population             | Jaipur           | 66.26 lakh       |
| Density                | Jaipur           | 595 per sq km    |
| Area                   | Jaisalmer        | 38,401 sq km     |
| Decadal growth         | Barmer           | about 32.5%      |
| Sex ratio              | Dungarpur        | 994              |
| Child sex ratio        | Banswara         | 934              |
| Literacy (overall)     | Kota             | 76.56%           |
| Male literacy          | Jhunjhunu        | about 86.9%      |
| Female literacy        | Kota             | about 65.9%      |
| Urbanisation           | Kota             | about 60.3%      |
| ST share of population | Banswara         | highest in state |
| SC share of population | Sri Ganganagar   | highest in state |

### LOWEST district for each indicator - Census 2011

| Indicator              | Lowest district | Figure            |
|------------------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| Population             | Jaisalmer       | 6.69 lakh         |
| Density                | Jaisalmer       | 17 per sq km      |
| Area                   | Dholpur         | about 3,034 sq km |
| Decadal growth         | Sri Ganganagar  | about 10%         |
| Sex ratio              | Dholpur         | 846               |
| Child sex ratio        | Jhunjhunu       | 837               |
| Literacy (overall)     | Jalore          | 54.86%            |
| Male literacy          | Pratapgarh      | lowest in state   |
| Female literacy        | Jalore          | about 38.5%       |
| Urbanisation           | Dungarpur       | about 6.4%        |
| ST share of population | Nagaur          | about 0.2%        |
| SC share of population | Dungarpur       | lowest in state   |

Two ordering facts sit just below the top of these lists, and RPSC has asked them as sequence questions. Sex ratio order at the top: Dungarpur (994), then Rajsamand (990), then Pali (987). Population order at the top: Jaipur (66.26 lakh), Jodhpur (36.87 lakh), Alwar (36.74 lakh), Nagaur (about 33.07 lakh). Jodhpur and Alwar are separated by barely thirteen thousand people, so their order is a favourite trap.

#### ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2023 - which district has the highest sex ratio in Rajasthan? Answer: Dungarpur (994). Asked in RAS Pre 2016 as an ordering question - Dungarpur > Rajsamand > Pali, with Dholpur (846) at the bottom. Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - highest literacy district: Kota (76.56%).

**TRAP**

Three districts wear two hats and RPSC uses it. Jhunjhunu has the HIGHEST male literacy and the LOWEST child sex ratio - prosperity did not fix the sex ratio there. Dungarpur has the HIGHEST sex ratio and the LOWEST urbanisation. Jaisalmer is the LARGEST district by area and the SMALLEST by population, with the lowest density. Do not assume the lowest density is Barmer - it is Jaisalmer. Barmer's claim is the highest decadal growth.

## Rural, urban and the towns of Rajasthan

Rajasthan is a rural state. Three out of four Rajasthanis lived in villages in 2011. The urban share of 24.89% - roughly 1.70 crore people - is well below the national 31.16%. The reason is geography plus economy: a large desert district like Jaisalmer or Barmer has almost no urban base, and the southern tribal districts are the least urbanised of all.

- Urban population 24.89% (about 1.70 crore); rural 75.11%.
- India's urban share in 2011 was 31.16% - Rajasthan is below it.
- Most urbanised districts: Kota (about 60.3%), Jaipur (52.4%), Ajmer (40.1%).
- Least urbanised: Dungarpur (about 6.4%), then Banswara and Pratapgarh.
- Million-plus cities in Census 2011 - exactly three: Jaipur, Jodhpur and Kota.
- Jaipur is the only Rajasthan city above 30 lakh; it is the state's only metropolitan-scale city.
- Do not confuse district urbanisation with city size - RPSC mixes them deliberately.
- Only THREE million-plus cities in Census 2011: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota.

- Ajmer is NOT a million-plus city, even though Ajmer district is the third most urbanised.
- Class of towns: Rajasthan's urban system is dominated by small and medium towns; Jaipur alone is of metropolitan scale.

One more contrast worth carrying. Kota is the most urbanised district AND the most literate district. That is not a coincidence - it is the coaching-and-industry town of the state. Dungarpur is the least urbanised AND has the best sex ratio. Urbanisation and sex ratio in Rajasthan run in opposite directions, which is the reverse of the usual textbook assumption.

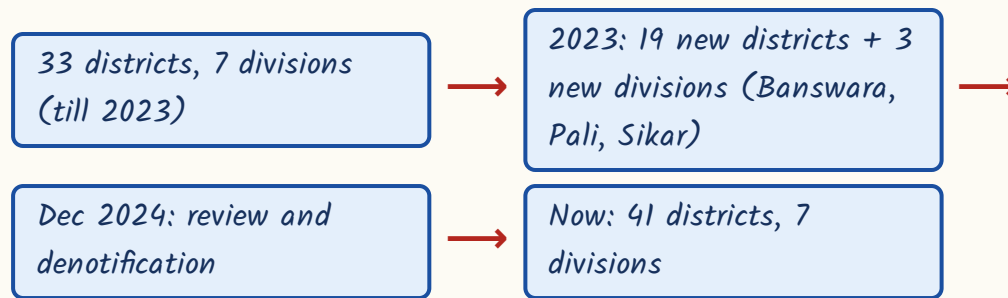
- Religion, Census 2011: Hindu 88.49%, Muslim 9.07%, Sikh 1.27%, Jain 0.91%, Christian 0.14%.
- Sikhs are concentrated in Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh - the canal-colony districts.
- Work participation rate of Rajasthan in 2011 was ABOVE the all-India average.
- Female work participation is unusually high in the western districts - women do the livestock and field work.
- Rajasthan is a net OUT-migration state; the flow goes to Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.

## **The administrative map as it stands now - 41 districts, 7 divisions**

This part is not census data at all - it is current affairs, and it changed twice in two years. In 2023 the state created nineteen new districts and three new divisions. In December 2024 the government reviewed that decision and denotified several of them. Learn the position as it stands now, and learn the divisions by name, because divisions are a short and therefore very askable list.



### How the district map moved - keep the sequence



- Present position (as of 2026): 41 districts in 7 divisions.
- The seven divisions: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Bikaner, Bharatpur, Udaipur.
- The three divisions created in 2023 - Banswara, Pali and Sikar - were abolished in December 2024.
- Eight of the districts created in 2023 were retained in the December 2024 rationalisation.
- Census 2011 district data still uses the OLD 33-district map - never mix the two.
- Phalodi, Balotra, Didwana-Kuchaman, Deeg and Kotputli-Behror did not exist in 2011.
- If a question says 'as per Census 2011', the answer must be one of the 33 old districts.

Two other administrative facts that ride along with this chapter. Rajasthan announced its State Population Policy in the year 2000 - the year is the whole question. And the Tribal Sub-Plan strategy, which shapes the tribal districts' budgets, began in the Fifth Five Year Plan, 1974-75.

### Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes - shares and where they live

Two numbers, and then the geography. SCs are 17.83% of Rajasthan's population - about 1.22 crore. STs are 13.48% - about 92.38 lakh. The SC population is spread fairly evenly across the state; the ST population is not. Tribal Rajasthan is a compact block in the south and south-east, plus the Meena belt in the eastern plains.

### SC and ST - the four distribution facts RPSC matches

| Question asked               | Answer                            | Watch out                         |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Highest ST share (%)         | Banswara, then Dungarpur          | Then Pratapgarh, Udaipur          |
| Highest ST number (absolute) | Udaipur district                  | NOT Banswara - Udaipur is bigger  |
| Lowest ST share              | Nagaur (about 0.2%), then Bikaner | The desert north has almost no ST |
| Highest SC share (%)         | Sri Ganganagar                    | Canal colony district             |
| Highest SC number (absolute) | Jaipur district                   | Biggest district overall          |
| Lowest SC share              | Dungarpur                         | Because it is overwhelmingly ST   |

#### ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the ST share of Rajasthan's population as per Census 2011? Answer: 13.48% (about 92.38 lakh). Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and 2021 - the district with the highest proportion of Scheduled Tribes? Answer: Banswara.

#### TRAP

Share versus number. Banswara has the highest ST PROPORTION; Udaipur has the largest ST POPULATION in absolute terms. Same trap on the SC side: Sri Ganganagar has the highest SC proportion, Jaipur has the largest SC population. Read whether the question says 'percentage' or 'number'.

*Why the pattern? The southern districts - Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur - are the Bhil hill country, forested and difficult, so the tribal population was never displaced. The eastern plains around Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa and Karauli are Meena country, agricultural and settled. Nagaur and Bikaner in the arid north-west never had a tribal base at all. Understand this map and the district answers stop being arbitrary.*

## **The tribes of Rajasthan - the master table**

*Rajasthan has twelve notified Scheduled Tribes. You need four of them in detail and the rest by one identifying feature each. The order by population is the first thing asked: Meena is the largest, Bhil second, Garasia third, Sahariya the smallest of the significant ones but the most vulnerable.*

### **The four major tribes - district, feature, keyword**

| Tribe           | Where they live                                                   | Distinctive fact                                                    |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Meena<br>(Mina) | Eastern plains - Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa, Karauli           | LARGEST tribe of Rajasthan; settled cultivators                     |
| Bhil            | Southern hills - Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh         | Second largest; hamlet called 'palli' or 'phala'; Gavri dance-drama |
| Garasia         | Sirohi (Abu Road, Pindwara), Udaipur (Kotra, Jhadol), Pali (Bali) | Third largest; shifting cultivation called 'Walra'                  |
| Sahariya        | Kishanganj and Shahbad tehsils of Baran (the Dang region)         | The ONLY PVTG of Rajasthan; headman called 'Kotwal'                 |

### **The smaller tribes and nomadic communities - one line each**

| Community | Where                                              | Identifying fact                               |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Damor     | Simalwara and Aspur (Dungarpur), parts of Banswara | Village head called 'Mukhi'; Chadwa Tirth fair |

| Community                                 | Where                              | Identifying fact                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Kathodi                                   | Kotra, Jhadol and Sarada (Udaipur) | Migrants from Maharashtra; make 'katha' (catechu) from khair wood |
| Kanjar                                    | Scattered, chiefly Hadoti          | Denotified nomadic community                                      |
| Sansi                                     | Scattered, chiefly Bharatpur-Alwar | Denotified nomadic community                                      |
| Rabari / Raika                            | Pali, Jodhpur, Nagaur, Sirohi      | Camel and sheep herders - the state's pastoralists                |
| Gadia Lohar                               | Nomadic, all over the state        | Wandering blacksmiths; trace descent to Chittorgarh               |
| Bhil-Mina, Dhanka, Naik, Patelia, Seharla | Southern and eastern districts     | All notified Scheduled Tribes of Rajasthan                        |

**ASKED IN RAS**

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 - the largest Scheduled Tribe of Rajasthan? Answer: Meena (Mina), with Bhil second. RPSC repeats this because students instinctively answer 'Bhil'.

**TRAP**

Two hard traps here. One: the largest tribe is the MEENA, not the Bhil. Two: the Sahariya live in BARAN district, not in Dungarpur or Banswara - and they are Rajasthan's only Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group. Three, a bonus: the Toda are a tribe of the Nilgiris in Tamil Nadu, not of Rajasthan; RPSC has slipped it into a list of Rajasthani STs.

## Tribal customs and vocabulary - the words that get matched

RPSC does not ask you to describe tribal society. It asks you to match a word to a tribe. So learn the vocabulary as pairs. There are about eight words that

carry almost every question in this part of the chapter.

### Tribal vocabulary - word to tribe, learn as pairs

| Word                             | Tribe    | What it means                                           |
|----------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Palli / Phala                    | Bhil     | The scattered hamlet the Bhil live in                   |
| Chimata                          | Bhil     | Shifting cultivation on a hill SLOPE                    |
| Dajiya                           | Bhil     | Shifting cultivation on LEVEL land                      |
| Gavri                            | Bhil     | Their famous dance-drama, performed after Rakshabandhan |
| Walra                            | Garasia  | Their slash-and-burn cultivation                        |
| Mor-bandiya, Peharavani, Taanana | Garasia  | Three of their forms of marriage                        |
| Gol-Gadheda                      | Garasia  | Their fair, where a bride may be won                    |
| Kotwal                           | Sahariya | The village headman                                     |
| Mukhi                            | Damor    | The village or panchayat head                           |
| Chadwa Tirth                     | Damor    | Their fair                                              |
| Katha                            | Kathodi  | Catechu, extracted from khair wood                      |

#### ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 and again in 2018 - 'Walra' is the shifting cultivation of which tribe? Answer: the Garasia. The Bhil equivalents are Chimata and Dajiya. This pair of terms is one of the most repeated facts in Rajasthan Geography.

- Memory hooks for the two headmen - Sahariya has the Kotwal, Damor has the Mukhi.
- Kotwal sounds like a police title; the Sahariya are the group that needed protection.
- Shifting cultivation - Garasia is Walra; Bhil is Chimata on the slope and Dajiya on flat land.

- Chimata from 'chadhai', the climb - that fixes it to the hill slope.

### **Bhil vs Meena - the two big tribes, opposite in almost everything**

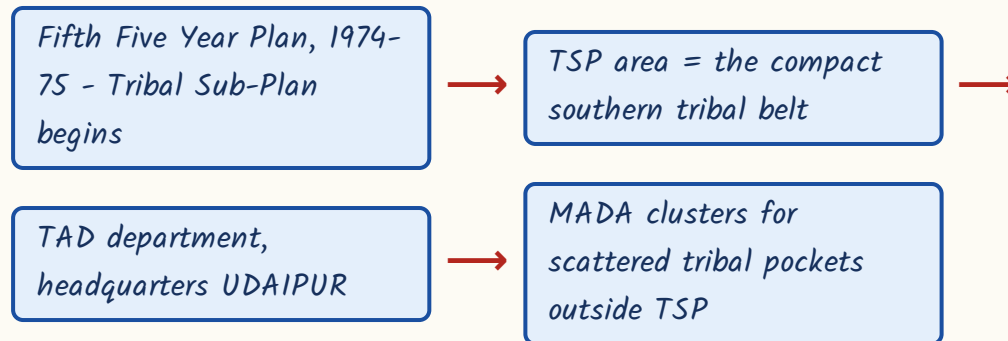
| <b>Bhil</b>                                               | <b>Meena (Mina)</b>                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Second largest tribe                                      | LARGEST tribe of Rajasthan                                            |
| Southern hills - Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh | Eastern plains - Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa, Karauli               |
| Forest-edge, shifting cultivation (Chimata, Dajiya)       | Settled plough agriculture, landholding community                     |
| Hamlet settlement called palli/phala                      | Village settlement, integrated with the plains economy                |
| Gavri dance-drama; strongly distinct culture              | Historically ruling and land-owning; heavy presence in state services |

One more thing about the Bhil that shows up in the History paper too. Bhil territory is where the Eki movement of Motilal Tejawat took root, and Bhil archers appear throughout Mewar's military history. If the question names Banswara-Dungarpur-Udaipur, the tribe is Bhil, whatever the paper is.

### **Tribal administration, migration and the last-minute sweep**

The delivery machinery for tribal development is a small, clean list and it is asked as a straight one-liner. The Tribal Area Development department has its headquarters at Udaipur - not Jaipur, which is the surprise. The Tribal Sub-Plan approach began in the Fifth Five Year Plan, 1974-75. And MADA - Modified Area Development Approach - exists for tribal pockets scattered outside the compact TSP area.

### How tribal development is organised in Rajasthan



- TAD (Tribal Area Development) department headquarters - Udaipur.
- Tribal Sub-Plan launched in the Fifth Five Year Plan (1974-75).
- MADA covers scattered tribal pockets outside the main TSP block.
- The TSP block is essentially Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh and parts of Udaipur, Sirohi and Chittorgarh.
- Rajasthan's State Population Policy was announced in 2000.
- Rajasthan is a net out-migration state - the streams go to Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.

#### ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 as a four-pair matching question - highest sex ratio Dungarpur (994), highest literacy Kota (76.56%), largest population Jaipur (66.26 lakh), highest child sex ratio Banswara (934). Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - the district with the highest decadal growth 2001-11? Answer: Barmer (about 32.5%).

#### YAAD RAKHO

Last-minute drill. Say these five aloud: Jaipur is the biggest everything except area. Jaisalmer is the emptiest everything except area, where it is the biggest. Kota is the most literate and most urban. Dungarpur is the best sex ratio and the least urban. Jalore is the least literate. Those five sentences cover most of the district questions this chapter can throw.



## REVISION RECAP

1. All Rajasthan population data in the paper = Census 2011. Next census notified for 2027 (as of September 2026).
2. 6,85,48,437 persons = 5.66% of India; 8th in population, 1st in area.
3. Decadal growth 21.31% against India's 17.70%; down from 28.41% in 1991-2001.
4. Density 200 (India 382), up from 165 in 2001. Sex ratio 928 (India 943). Child sex ratio 888 (India 919).
5. Literacy 66.11% - male 79.19%, female 52.12%; a 27-point gender gap, widest among major states.
6. Highest: Jaipur population and density, Kota literacy and urbanisation, Dungarpur sex ratio, Banswara child sex ratio, Barmer growth, Jhunjhunu male literacy.
7. Lowest: Jaisalmer population and density, Jalore literacy, Dholpur sex ratio and area, Jhunjhunu child sex ratio, Dungarpur urbanisation, Sri Ganganagar growth.
8. Top sex ratios in order - Dungarpur 994, Rajsamand 990, Pali 987. Bottom - Dholpur 846.
9. Top populations in order - Jaipur 66.26, Jodhpur 36.87, Alwar 36.74, Nagaur 33.07 lakh.
10. Urban 24.89% vs India 31.16%. Only three million-plus cities: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota.
11. Religion 2011: Hindu 88.49, Muslim 9.07, Sikh 1.27, Jain 0.91, Christian 0.14 per cent.
12. SC 17.83% (1.22 crore); ST 13.48% (92.38 lakh).
13. ST share highest Banswara; ST number highest Udaipur; ST share lowest Nagaur. SC share highest Sri Ganganagar; SC number highest Jaipur.
14. Tribe order by size: Meena > Bhil > Garasia; Sahariya is the state's only PVTG, in Baran.
15. Bhil = palli/phala, Chimata and Dajiya, Gavri. Garasia = Walra, Gol-Gadheda, Morbandiya.
16. Sahariya headman = Kotwal; Damor head = Mukhi; Kathodi make katha from khair wood.
17. Rabari/Raika herd camels and sheep; Gadia Lohar are nomadic blacksmiths from Chittorgarh; Kanjar and Sansi are denotified communities.
18. TAD headquarters Udaipur; Tribal Sub-Plan from the Fifth Plan, 1974-75; MADA for scattered pockets.
19. State Population Policy 2000; Rajasthan is a net out-migration state towards Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.
20. Administrative map now: 41 districts in 7 divisions - Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Bikaner, Bharatpur, Udaipur.